



COST-MANDATE MOTION /// ONE-OFF STRIKE ROOM

TELUS Corporation

Buying-committee strike sequences for a company that quietly raised its own restructuring envelope by a hundred million, named operational effectiveness as the reason, and promised better customer service in the same breath.

\$600M

FY2026
RESTRUCTURING
ASSUMPTION,
REVISED UP
\$100M

3.2x

Q1 2026
RESTRUCTURING
VS Q1 2025,
\$315M V \$97M

32%

AI QA AND
COACHING
DEPLOYED,
THEIR OWN
RESEARCH

Sep 8

LAUNCH, WEEK
TWO OF THE
NEW GROUP
PRESIDENT

Why TELUS, why now

TELUS Corporation (TSX: T / NYSE: TU). Canada's second-largest telecommunications company by revenue, Vancouver-headquartered, 111,500 team members globally as of December 31, 2025. Confirmed non-customer: screened independently against Nathan's Salesforce Active Customer Account Report (Jul 10, 2026), 101 active accounts, by industry and by country rather than by name. Neither TELUS nor any TELUS entity appears. The exclusions this account creates are listed in the guardrails section, and one of them matters more here than on either of the other two accounts.

The forcing function

The July 22 reorganisation is the headline, and it is not the forcing function. The forcing function was disclosed eleven weeks earlier, in a filing, with a number attached.

In its Q1 2026 MD&A on May 8, 2026, TELUS revised its own full-year restructuring assumption upward and stated the reason, verbatim:

"Our restructuring and other costs assumption has been revised to approximately \$600 million, from approximately \$500 million."

"We estimate total cash restructuring and other disbursements of approximately \$550 million, from approximately \$450 million."

"The increase is a result of expanded operational effectiveness programs to support EBITDA and cash flow growth."

That is a named program, a hundred-million-dollar upward revision, a stated rationale and a fiscal year. It is the TELUS equivalent of BCE's \$1.5 billion and BMO's \$250 million, and unlike either of those it is a revision rather than an announcement, which means the programs were already running and turned out to need more room.

The run rate confirms it. Q1 2026 restructuring and other costs were **\$315 million against \$97 million in Q1 2025**, a 3.2x increase, which TELUS attributes to:

"cost efficiency and effectiveness programs, in addition to costs associated with the privatization of TELUS Digital"

The tension the whole sequence hangs on

TELUS has committed publicly to a position on how it gets there, and that position closes off the obvious lever.

TELUS's official statement on AI in its own contact centres, verbatim:

"We believe AI, when used responsibly, can augment — not replace — human capabilities and help deliver better outcomes for our customers and communities."

And the July 22 reorganisation release asks for two things in a single sentence, verbatim:

"This reorganization is designed to drive enhanced customer service, align capital and resources to the highest margin products, services and customer segments, and realize operational efficiencies across the organization."

Read those together and the shape of the problem is specific. TELUS needs \$600 million of operational effectiveness. It has said the customer service experience has to get *better*, not just cheaper, in the same sentence. And it has put on the record that its answer to automation is augmentation rather than replacement. Capacity recovered from inside the existing workforce is the one lever that serves all three of those at once: it does not require a reduction, it does not trade against service, and it is the literal definition of augmenting the people already there.

This is the entire opening, and it is TELUS's own language on both sides of it. **The copy leads with the customer-service half of that sentence, never the efficiency half.** See the guardrails section for why that is not a stylistic preference.

The structural objection, which is also the best thing about this account

TELUS Digital, formerly TELUS International, wholly owned by TELUS Corporation since the privatization closed October 31, 2025, sells contact-centre AI and CX outsourcing commercially to third-party enterprises. It is a Genesys CCaaS and Workforce Engagement Management implementation partner, it announced a Cresta

partnership on June 15, 2026, and it markets its own AI platform, Fuel iX, including Agent Assist and Agent Trainer.

So "we do this ourselves" is structural here rather than incidental, and it is the reason the entity-resolution work behind the committee was not optional.

The answer is not to route around it. It is to lead into it, using TELUS Digital's own published research.

TELUS Digital, with Ryan Strategic Advisory, published *Enterprise CX AI: 2026 Global Survey* on June 3, 2026: 815 enterprise CX decision-makers, 12 countries, 19 verticals, fielded Q1 2026. Its finding, verbatim:

"only 32% of enterprises selected AI-powered quality assurance (QA) and agent coaching"

and

"two-thirds lack the AI-powered QA and coaching tools needed to assess AI-assisted interactions at scale"

Their own research group put the number at 32%, and **46% say they plan to invest**, a fourteen-point gap between intent and deployment. The opener writes itself: their own arm published the gap, and the interesting question is which side of it TELUS Corporation is on.

That does three things at once. It proves the research was done. It makes the "we do this ourselves" objection the subject of the conversation rather than the end of it. And it is unarguable, because they published it.

The distinction to hold underneath, and the line the copy must not cross.

TELUS Digital sells CX services to other companies; that is a revenue line, and its research is about *other enterprises*. It says nothing about how TELUS Corporation runs its own operation. The copy asks which side of the number TELUS is on. It never asserts that TELUS is one of the 68%. That inference is unsourced and a TELUS executive will spot it instantly.

The tech stack is a discovery question, not a claim

Verint Workforce Engagement was deployed to approximately 30,000 TELUS International team members, announced **May 20, 2021**, five years ago, and explicitly at TELUS International rather than TELUS Corporation. There is no 2024-

2026 confirmation it remains in place, and TELUS Digital rebranded, went private and re-platformed around its own AI stack in the interim.

What is current and public is that TELUS Digital positions **Genesys Workforce Engagement Management** on its CCaaS pages, and that **Fuel iX Agent Assist and Agent Trainer are mandated inside TELUS's own call centres**: a January 2026 internal email obtained by CBC requires agent co-pilot use on "100% of retention calls."

Treat the workforce-management platform as a question to ask, never a fact to assert. No message in this document names Verint, NICE or Calabrio as TELUS's stack.

Recent financial context (company-disclosed)

- **Q1 2026** (reported May 8, 2026): operating revenue \$5.0 billion, down 1%. Adjusted EBITDA \$1.8 billion, flat. Free cash flow \$583 million, up 19%. Net income \$144 million, down 52%. Restructuring and other costs \$315 million.
- **2026 targets** (set February 12, 2026): consolidated service revenue growth 2-4%, adjusted EBITDA growth 2-4%, free cash flow approximately \$2.45 billion (10% growth), capital expenditures approximately \$2.3 billion (a 10% decrease).
- TELUS names "**cost reduction efforts, including workforce reductions, synergies achieved from the privatization of TELUS Digital, and reductions in marketing and administrative costs**" as the EBITDA drivers.
- TELUS Digital privatization synergies: a **\$150-200 million** annual cash synergy target, with approximately **\$115 million** in annualized free cash flow synergies realized as at Q1 2026.
- **AI revenue: approximately \$800 million in 2025, targeted at approximately \$2 billion by 2028.** Useful for framing the conversation in TELUS's growth language rather than its cost language.
- Fiscal year end: **December 31.** There is no October fiscal close to work against, unlike BMO.

Calendar anchor

- **Victor Dodig** became President and CEO **July 1, 2026**, 29 days in seat at build time. Previously President and CEO of CIBC (2014-2025) and a TELUS independent director since May 2022. Announced February 12, 2026.
- **Gopi Chande** became CFO **July 1, 2026**, announced May 8, 2026. She was **CFO of TELUS Digital and TELUS Health**, an internal promotion rather than an outside hire. She personally owns the financial model of an 80,000-person CX outsourcing business and now owns the \$600 million restructuring envelope. There is nobody at TELUS who needs less education on contact-centre unit economics.

- **Darren Entwistle** retired June 30, 2026 after 26 years, left the Board the same day, holds the honorary title CEO Emeritus and advises Dodig until April 30, 2027. **Not a buying-committee member.**
- **David Fuller** becomes **Executive Vice President and Group President, TELUS Communications** on **September 1, 2026**, with Consumer Solutions and Business Solutions both under him. He is a boomerang: he left TELUS in 2019, advised BCG's telecom practice, was **President of Rogers Wireless (2021-2022)**, and most recently was an Operating Partner at **Searchlight Capital Partners**. He will arrive with a private-equity operator's lens and he is not sequenced here. He is the escalation.
- **Zainul Mawji**, previously EVP TELUS Consumer Solutions, is **departing** after 25 years. She is the person the reorganisation removed. **Do not contact her.** Any prior research listing her as the consumer customer-experience owner is dead.
- **Q2 2026 earnings** have not been reported and the date is **not company-confirmed**. TELUS investor relations does not list it. Third-party aggregators converge on **Friday, August 7, 2026**, around 12:30 PM ET, and TELUS's own pattern (Q2 2025 was August 1) supports early August. It will be Dodig's and Chande's first call together. **Treat August 7 as a planning assumption only and never state it to a prospect.**
- **Launch: the week of September 8, 2026.** Note that **Monday September 7 is Labour Day in Canada**, so Day 1 is Tuesday September 8. Fuller's first week is triage; week two is when a new group president starts asking what is already in motion.
- USW Local 1944's collective agreement runs to **March 31, 2027**, and 2026 bargaining preparation is already underway. This is context for why TELUS needs capacity that does not read as headcount reduction. **It is never mentioned in a message.**

Buying committee

Eight seats, all sourced live via Clay on July 29-30 2026. Seven addresses swept through ZeroBounce before any copy was written; six cleared. Two seats are LinkedIn-only by design.

#	NAME	TITLE	TIER	EMAIL	ZB STATUS	ANGLE
1	Hesham Fahmy	Executive Vice President, Chief Operations Officer and Chief Information Officer	1 (exec sponsor)	hesham.fahmy@telus.com	Valid, no flags	The two halves of his title are the two halves of the \$600 million problem, and he is the only person who does not have to negotiate across them. Six months in the combined role (February 2026), confirmed in seat after the July 22 reorganisation. Extended arc. Entry Day 4.
2	Ben Bajaj	Vice President, Customer Service Excellence Operations	2 (floor owner)	ben.bajaj@telus.com	Valid, no flags	His title contains both halves of TELUS's own July 22 sentence. Eleven months in seat (September 2025), through the reorganisation. Entry seat,

**Day 1.
Extended
arc.**

3	Dave Richardson	Senior Vice President, Business Customer Experience	2 (champion)	dave.richardson@telus.com	Valid, no flags	B2B care, where a service failure costs a contract rather than a line. Business Solutions folds under Fuller from September 1. Five years in seat (February 2021).
4	Dionne Dames	Director, Contact Center AI, Digital and Sales Acceleration	3 (technical)	Unresolved for business use	Not swept	The single best seat for the TELUS Digital question, because contact-centre AI is literally her remit. LinkedIn-only. Entry Day 1. Clay returned only a consumer @telus.net ISP mailbox, see the note below.
5	Brad Harper	Vice President, Workforce Solutions	3 (technical)	Unresolved	Not swept	The workforce-management owner. Twenty-eight years at TELUS (August 1998), which makes him the person who knows what the stack actually is. LinkedIn-

**only. Entry
Day 2.**

6	Megan Routly	Director, Client Service Management	3 (operational)	megan.routly@telus.com	Valid, no flags	Closest to the daily reality, the escalation layer that absorbs the distance between the roster and the day. Carries the single humility clause. Entry Day 1.
7	Matt Murray, FCPA, FCMA	Senior Vice-President, Finance Business Partners	4 (economic)	matthew.murray@telus.com	Valid, no flags	Finance Business Partners is the function that sits with operating units and holds them to their number, which makes the \$600 million his file in the most literal sense. Nearly five years in seat (December 2021). Entry Day 4. Touches 1 and 4 carry a [PENDING Q2 CALL] swap.
8	Lynn Salekin	Vice President, Finance Shared Services	5 (back office)	lynn.salekin@telus.com	Valid, no flags	The back-office seat, and the only one in the set with no contact-centre content at all. Four years in seat (April

ZeroBounce sweep, July 30 2026. Run in workbook `One0ff_ZB_Sweep_Jul29`, new table `TELUS_Committee_ZB` added alongside the Bell and BMO tables from the day before. Nine rows, **0.9 credits**, page-verified: "~0.9 total" on the pre-run panel, "100% of table completed" after, Status column read verbatim.

Result: **six of nine valid**. Three failures, and they matter:

ADDRESS	STATUS	SUB STATUS	DISPOSITION
ian.godfrey@telus.com	abuse	none returned	Never send. Ian Godfrey, Manager Contact Center Evolution, was the ninth candidate seat and is now off the list entirely. An <code>abuse</code> status means the address has been used to report mail as spam. Sending to it risks the sending domain, not just the reply.
jen.elson@telus.com	invalid	mailbox_not_found	Bench address. Dropped.
dave.visconti@telus.com	invalid	mailbox_not_found	Bench address. Dropped.

Two bench addresses were swept alongside the seven candidate seats for 0.2 extra so that a failure on a primary would not need a second billable pass. **Both bench addresses failed**, so the bench gave zero cover this time. That is an honest bad outcome for the tactic rather than a reason to abandon it: it cost 0.2 credits, and it is why Ian Godfrey's `abuse` flag did not force a second run to find a replacement.

Entity resolution, and the trap this account was always going to set

`telus.com` resolved cleanly on the **first** call, unlike BMO. The company object returned TELUS, `linkedin.com/company/telus`, Vancouver, British Columbia, CA, Telecommunications, `annual_revenue` 10B-100B. That is TELUS Corporation, the parent. Two searches, as planned, versus BMO's five.

Reading the company object first was still what caught the real problem, which was not at the company level but inside the returned contacts. **Three contacts carrying TELUS job titles and `telus.com` as their listed domain resolved to a different corporate email domain entirely:**

CONTACT	TITLE AS RETURNED	EMAIL RESOLVED	VERDICT
Maddy Baker	Vice President, Customer Experience Excellence,	maddy.baker@ telusagcg.com	Different entity. Dropped.

TELUS Agriculture & Consumer Goods			
Carlos Cabrero	Global Delivery Director, Customer Experience Excellence, TELUS Agriculture & Consumer Goods	carlos.cabrero@telusagcg.com	Different entity. Dropped.
Jessica Smith	Human Resources Business Partner Manager, CIO	jessica.smith@telusagcg.com	Title gave no hint. Only the domain did. Dropped.

TELUS Agriculture & Consumer Goods sits under Navin Arora's Global Platform Businesses after the reorganisation, not under TELUS Communications. Jessica Smith is the instructive one: nothing in her title indicated a different entity, and the enriched email was the only signal.

A second trap, specific to this account and worth carrying forward. Four contacts resolved to addresses at **telus.net** :

CONTACT	EMAIL RESOLVED
Dionne Dames	ddames@telus.net
Lisa Richardson	lisarichardson@telus.net
Margaux Walker	walker@telus.net
Carol Craig	craig@telus.net

telus.net is **TELUS's consumer internet service provider mail domain**, not its corporate domain. These are personal home mailboxes that happen to sit on the employer's own ISP. Sending business outreach there is worse than sending to a bad address: it lands in someone's private inbox, from a stranger, about their job. All four were dropped for sequencing. Dionne Dames was too valuable to lose entirely, so she moved to LinkedIn-only rather than being replaced.

Also dropped on inspection, before any credit was spent on validation:

- **Victor Shewchuk**, returned inside a **telus.com** people search, but his current company is VisionWorks Consulting Group and his domain came back null. Not TELUS. The BMO Austrian-consultancy pattern, at contact level rather than company level.
- **Robert Cook**, whose title reads "Retired - VP Operations". **robert.cook@telus.com** validated as a real address. Retired is retired.

- **Michael McDonald**, mm@telus.com, a two-character alias on a "Corporate Client Support" title held since 2009. Too generic to trust and too junior to sequence.
- **Sandy McIntosh**, EVP People & Culture and CHRO, a valid address and deliberately not sequenced. TELUS is in an active public disagreement with its union about AI displacement in its call centres. The CHRO is the worst possible cold entry point for a workforce-automation conversation at this company, whatever the copy says.

What this committee deliberately does not include

Neither **David Fuller** nor **Gopi Chande** is sequenced. Fuller has no operational authority until September 1, and burning a brand-new group president on a cold email costs the one senior door that matters. Chande is 29 days into a CFO role and will spend the autumn on her first two earnings calls. Both are the escalation once a thread is warm, and "your team has been talking to us since September" is a far better first contact with either of them than a cold email in August.

This is the same judgment applied to Mehrotra and Haward-Laird on BMO, for the same reason.

What reps can and cannot say

Say

- Anything TELUS has published, with the date attached. The \$600 million restructuring assumption and the \$500 million it replaced, the "expanded operational effectiveness programs" rationale, the \$315 million versus \$97 million quarter, the July 22 "enhanced customer service" and "operational efficiencies" language, Dodig's "first step in a transformation", the 2026 targets, the \$2 billion AI revenue target, and their stated position that AI should augment rather than replace.
- **TELUS Digital's own research, quoted precisely.** 32% of enterprises deploying AI-powered quality assurance and agent coaching; 46% planning to invest. *Enterprise CX AI: 2026 Global Survey*, TELUS Digital with Ryan Strategic Advisory, June 3 2026. Quote the number and the source. **Ask which side of it TELUS is on; never state which side.**
- Intradiem's approved positioning if a frame is needed: Dynamic Workforce Orchestration, spanning contact centre and back office. That positioning statement is the whole of what is cleared here. **No platform headcount figure, no retention or growth percentage, no company statistic of any kind** — the Value Repository was frozen as a prospect-facing source on Jul 21 2026 (Matt Graves, with Naveen), and the cleared-to-ship allowlist is three items: the DWO positioning statement, the Humana webinar claims in the bullet below, and public CMS Star Ratings math with the estimate label attached (not applicable to TELUS). Anything else, including any figure sourced from intradiem.com or a press release, is **[UNVERIFIED]** for prospect-facing use until cleared.
- The Humana result (7X ROI five years in, approximately two hours of capacity per agent per month, 2.7 million automated actions in 2025) is publicly approved and named. **Replies and objection handling only, never in a cold touch.** This carries the Cardinal Health rule forward through Bell and BMO.
- Contact centre and back office together. TELUS's billing operations, order provisioning, credit and collections and finance shared services are as much of the story as the phone queue. Lynn Salekin's seat exists to prove that.

Do not say

- **Nothing that equates efficiency with fewer people.** No "do more with less", no "reduce headcount", no "cost per agent", no framing where the win is a smaller team. This is the hardest rule in the document and the reason for it is specific: TELUS's own public position is that AI should augment rather than replace, it is in an

active union dispute about AI displacement in its call centres, and customer-service roles were cut inside the TELUS group two weeks before this document was written. The only safe frame is **capacity and service quality recovered from the workforce already there** — which is also TELUS's own language, "drive enhanced customer service."

- **No idle-time percentage. No efficiency statistic of Intradiem's own.** Blocked in the Value Repository, and the cost-mandate motion frames from the prospect's own stated pressure rather than a manufactured number.
- **No ROI, savings or payback figure for TELUS.** No modelled dollar amount, no "typical customer sees" claim.
- **No TELUS contact-centre headcount, agent count, footprint or location.** TELUS does not disclose them anywhere; its own contact-centre careers page gives only "15.9 million Residential and wireless subscribers" and no operational figures. Any agent count in a prospect-facing asset would be fabricated. Do not estimate one.
- **No job-cut, layoff, severance or workforce-reduction framing of any kind.** The 2,800 Canadian roles lost in 2025 and the 28,000-to-25,200 decline are both derivable from TELUS's own annual report, and quoting a company's job losses back at its executives is hostile rather than insightful. The July 15 2026 customer-service cuts at ADT by Telus in Calgary are doubly barred: hostile, and **ADT is an active Intradiem customer**, so naming it breaches the customer-naming gate as well.
- **No union reference.** Not the United Steelworkers, not Local 1944, not its president, not bargaining, not the March 2027 contract expiry. And **never Unifor**, which represents Bell workers, not TELUS workers. Getting that wrong in a message to a TELUS operations executive ends the conversation on the spot.
- **No CCTS complaint numbers.** The widely-quoted 78% increase is real but it is the largest year-over-year *increase*, not the worst complaint volume; Rogers held the highest share at 27% against TELUS's 21%. It also covers August 2024 to July 2025, which is a year stale, and the April 2026 mid-year report does not publish a TELUS-specific figure. Left out of every message on purpose, exactly as on Bell.
- **No Verint, NICE or Calabrio named as TELUS's stack.** The Verint evidence is a May 2021 TELUS International announcement, five years old and about a different entity. The stack is a discovery question.
- **No CRTC junk-fee reference.** TELUS is in live regulatory conflict about how it charges consumers, with up to \$10 million of exposure and a deadline suspended on July 29 2026. It is real, it is unresolved, and it is about billing consumers rather than about operations. Raising it reads as opposition research.
- **No Q2 2026 earnings date stated as fact.** August 7 is a third-party aggregator estimate. TELUS investor relations does not publish it. Being wrong about an executive's own calendar is disqualifying.

- **No \$200 million offshoring savings figure.** Attributed to a TELUS spokesperson by one outlet, absent from every TELUS filing, and not carried by a second outlet covering the same annual report. **[UNVERIFIED]**, do not use.
- **No named customer except Humana**, and Humana in replies only. Rogers is an active Intradiem customer and is TELUS's direct competitor: it is exactly the comparison a rep will reach for, and it is the one that must never be spoken. Charter, AT&T Enterprise Group, AT&T Entertainment Group, DIRECTV, Cox Communications, Cox Enterprises, Virgin Media O2, Capita and Foundever are also active customers in this vertical and none may be named. **Bell Canada is not a customer but is a live prospect with its own strike room built the same week; the two documents must never cross-reference each other.**

Cadence and committee choreography

Five-touch multi-channel core across about eight business days from each contact's entry day. Two contacts run the extended arc. Two run LinkedIn-only.

- **Touch 1 (Day 1)** Email. Why-now plus one hook specific to that seat.
- **Touch 2 (Day 2)** LinkedIn connection request carrying the opener.
- **Touch 3 (Day 4)** Voicemail plus a LinkedIn message the same day. **Every voicemail has a live-answer script behind it.** If they pick up, the rep does not read the voicemail out loud.
- **Touch 4 (Day 6)** Email. A genuinely new second angle.
- **Touch 5 (Day 9)** Breakup email.

Extended arc on Ben Bajaj and Hesham Fahmy: call #1 with a full script, call #2 shorter, then a hail-mary before the breakup. Escalation runs soft to direct to persistent. The order does not invert to fit a calendar.

LinkedIn-only on Dionne Dames and Brad Harper: connection request, then two messages spaced across the arc, then stop. No email, no voicemail, no breakup. If either engages, resolve the business address then, when it is worth something.

Staggered entry

Monday September 7 2026 is **Labour Day in Canada**. Day 1 is Tuesday.

DAY	DATE	CONTACTS ENTERING
Day 1	Tue Sep 8	Ben Bajaj (extended), Megan Routly, Dionne Dames (LinkedIn only)
Day 2	Wed Sep 9	Dave Richardson, Brad Harper (LinkedIn only)
Day 3	Thu Sep 10	Lynn Salekin
Day 4	Fri Sep 11	Hesham Fahmy (extended), Matt Murray

The operational and floor layer goes first so that by the time Hesham Fahmy enters on Day 4, the outreach has had time to surface upward through the people who would mention it. Ben Bajaj is the most likely internal forwarder in the set, because his title sits directly beneath the reorganisation's own language, and he is deliberately first.

Why the launch is held to September 8

Two reasons, and neither is David Fuller's start date on its own.

The reorganisation was announced on July 22. The directors and vice-presidents beneath the new structure do not yet know their own remit, who they report to, or what survives. That is the worst moment in a company's life to ask someone for twenty minutes about operational change: they have no authority to act and every incentive to defer. Six weeks fixes that.

And Fuller's first week is triage. Week two is when a new group president starts asking what is already in motion, and the objective is to already be a thread someone can point at.

There is no dark period inside this sequence, and that is a deliberate departure from Bell and BMO. Both of those went dark around an earnings call that fell inside the send window. TELUS's Q2 call is expected in early August, five weeks *before* Day 1, and its Q3 call will fall in early November, well after Day 9. Manufacturing a blackout here would be cargo-culting the last two documents. What replaces it is a pre-send gate: confirm the Q2 date, and if it has for any reason slipped into September, hold every touch within two business days either side of it.

The single-entity problem

Every seat in this committee sits in **TELUS Corporation**. None sits in TELUS Digital, TELUS Health or TELUS Agriculture & Consumer Goods, and that was verified per contact rather than assumed from the company object.

This matters more than a hygiene note. TELUS Digital is a wholly owned subsidiary that sells contact-centre AI, CX outsourcing and workforce-engagement implementation to the same enterprises Intradiem sells to. Selling into TELUS Corporation means selling into that subsidiary's parent. Every seat in this document will eventually ask some version of "why would we buy this when we own a company that sells it," and the answer has to be the same answer from all eight of them, or the thread dies the first time two of them compare notes.

The answer, held consistently across the committee: TELUS Digital sells CX services to other companies, and that is a revenue line. It says nothing about the tooling inside TELUS Corporation's own 111,500-person operation, and TELUS Digital's own research is the evidence that the specific layer in question, real-time quality assurance and agent coaching, is the least-deployed part of the market. The messaging is threaded so that the finance seats, the operations seats and the technical seats are visibly making the same argument from different angles, which is the point.

Deliverability

Six addresses into telus.com inside four days is a pattern-flag risk regardless of copy quality. The sweep came back clean on all six with no catch-all and no role-based flags, so placement is the only variable left. Every contact has a different subject line, no two openers share a structure, sends stagger across the day rather than clustering, and two of the eight seats never touch email at all, which lowers the domain volume as a side effect of a decision made for other reasons.

One address in the original nine came back **abuse**. That is a domain-level warning worth taking seriously: it means someone at telus.com has reported cold mail as spam recently enough to matter. Volume discipline is not optional here.

Hesham Fahmy

Executive Vice President, Chief Operations Officer
and Chief Information Officer

Hook. TELUS put operations and information under one executive in February. The \$600 million of operational effectiveness programs needs both, and he is the only person at TELUS who does not have to negotiate across that line to get them.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 1 • EMAIL

both halves

Hesham, most companies split operations and information across two executives, and the seam shows up in one predictable place. Operations needs capacity it cannot schedule and asks technology for it. Technology builds something that arrives quarterly. The floor moves hourly.

TELUS put both under you in February, which removes that negotiation. It also means the operational effectiveness programs behind the revised restructuring assumption land on one desk rather than two.

Intradiem works the hourly layer. Worth twenty minutes on where that sits relative to what you already run?

{{sender}}

[PENDING Q2 CALL] — if Chande names a specific operational-effectiveness target or a headcount-neutral commitment on the Q2 call, swap "the revised restructuring assumption" in paragraph two for her exact words plus the call date. A sitting CFO from three weeks ago beats an MD&A from four months ago.

TOUCH 2 • DAY 2 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Hesham, operations and information under one executive is unusual, and it happens to remove the exact seam I spend my time in: the gap between capacity technology can build on a quarterly cycle and capacity the floor needs the same afternoon. Would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • VOICEMAIL

Hesham, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent a note about your role covering both operations and information, and the fact that the seam between those two is usually where real-time capacity goes to die. TELUS removed the seam. I work the layer on the other side of it. I am at [number], and the email is easy to reply to. Thanks Hesham.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF HE PICKS UP OPENER

Hesham, {{sender}} with Intradiem. Thirty seconds, then tell me whether to keep going.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

Your role is why I called. When operations and technology are two people, real-time capacity is a negotiation, and it loses, because technology delivers on a quarterly cadence and the floor needs it inside the shift. You do not have that negotiation. So the question becomes narrower. Is anything at TELUS acting on floor conditions in the moment rather than reporting on them afterward?

CLOSE

Twenty minutes to see where that usually lands at your scale? I will work around your calendar.

IF HE WANTS THE ARCHITECTURE

An orchestration layer above your existing systems. It consumes real-time state from the contact centre platform and the workforce platform, evaluates rules against it continuously, and writes actions back. No rip and replace, no data migration, and the integration surface is smaller than people expect because we are reading state rather than owning it.

IF HE RAISES TELUS DIGITAL

Fair, and it would be my first question too. They sell CX services to other enterprises, which is a revenue line and a different question from what runs inside TELUS Corporation. Whether the two should converge is genuinely your call, not mine, and I would rather hear how you see it than argue a position.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Hesham, left you a voicemail as well. The short version: real-time capacity usually dies in the negotiation between operations and technology, and your role does not have that negotiation, which makes the remaining question a much narrower one. Worth twenty minutes to test whether it is already answered at TELUS?

the run rate already tells you

Hesham, a second thought, on arithmetic rather than structure.

The full-year restructuring assumption went up by a hundred million in May, with expanded operational effectiveness programs named as the cause. First-quarter restructuring and other costs were \$315 million against \$97 million a year earlier.

Read together, those say the programs are executing, not planning. Which makes the question a technical one rather than a financial one. Executing at that pace needs the systems to keep up with the operating model, and that is the half of this that reports to you rather than to finance.

Twenty minutes on the systems half?

{{sender}}

[PENDING Q2 CALL] — refresh both figures against Q2 actuals before this sends. If the half-year restructuring number is materially off a \$600 million annual pace, the "executing, not planning" reading either strengthens or breaks, and this email must not go out on stale arithmetic.

TOUCH 5 • DAY 8 • CALL #1, FULL SCRIPT

OPENER

Hesham, {{sender}} with Intradiem. I have sent two notes and I would rather ask you directly than send a third.

THE FRAME

TELUS has said three things that only fit together one way. Roughly \$600 million of restructuring driven by expanded operational effectiveness programs. A reorganisation whose own stated purpose is enhanced customer service as well as operational efficiencies. And a public position that AI should augment rather than replace. Take those seriously at the same time and the list of available levers is short. Capacity recovered from the people already there is on it. Most things are not.

THE ASK

I am not asking you to evaluate anything. Twenty minutes. If the answer is that TELUS has this covered, you will have spent twenty minutes and I will stop.

IF HE WANTS THE TECHNICAL SHAPE

We read real-time state from the platforms you already run and write actions back into them. The rules layer is ours, the systems of record stay yours.

TOUCH 6 • DAY 10 • CALL #2, SHORT

Hesham, {{sender}} with Intradiem again. One question and I will let you go. Of the operational effectiveness work running at TELUS right now, is any of it working the capacity side rather than the cost-base side? If yes, I will stop calling.

TOUCH 7 • DAY 12 • EMAIL, HAIL-MARY

one thing to leave behind

Hesham, I have not earned a reply and I am not going to keep asking for one.

One thing worth leaving behind. David Fuller arrives September 1 with Consumer and Business Solutions under him, from a private-equity operating seat. In my experience that arrival generates exactly one question in the first month: what is already in flight on the operational side. Whatever the answer is at TELUS, it is better to have it than to be assembling it.

If the capacity layer is ever the gap, the door is open.

{{sender}}

TOUCH 8 • DAY 14 • BREAKUP EMAIL

closing the loop

Hesham, closing this out. If the real-time layer becomes a question rather than a curiosity, I am easy to find.

{{sender}}

SEAT 2 OF 8

TIER 2

FLOOR OWNER

ENTRY DAY 1

Ben Bajaj

Vice President, Customer Service
Excellence Operations

EXTENDED ARC

Hook. TELUS's July 22 release asks for enhanced customer service and operational efficiencies in the same sentence. His title contains both of those words. He is the seat where the two either reconcile or trade against each other, and almost everywhere else they trade.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 1 • EMAIL

the same sentence

Ben, the July 22 release said the reorganisation was designed to drive enhanced customer service and to realise operational efficiencies across the organisation. Same sentence, two things.

Your title has both of those words in it, which means you are the person who finds out whether they reconcile or trade. In most operations I see they trade, and the trade gets made quietly at the agent's expense: a coaching session that does not happen, training deferred, the queue winning.

There is one lever that moves both the same direction, which is capacity recovered from inside the shift you already staffed. Twenty minutes?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 2 • DAY 2 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Ben, your title contains both halves of TELUS's own July 22 sentence: customer service, and operations. In most places those two trade against each other and someone quietly eats the difference. I work the one lever that moves both the same way. Would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • VOICEMAIL

Ben, {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent you a note about the July 22 language asking for better service and operational efficiency in the same breath, and how your title is where those two meet. There is one lever that does not force the trade between them. My number is [number], and replying to the email is easier. Thanks Ben.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF HE PICKS UP

OPENER

Ben, {{sender}} with Intradiem. Give me thirty seconds and then tell me to stop or keep going.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

Your title is the reason I called. Customer service excellence and operations in one title means you are accountable for two things that normally trade, and you are the one who feels it when they do. Every operation I walk into has the same physics. The queue wins, so coaching slips, so quality slips, so the queue gets worse. The only way out that does not cost headcount or service is capacity that already exists inside the shift and is not being used. Adherence gaps, between-contact time, the fifteen minutes that never becomes anything.

CLOSE

Twenty minutes to see what that usually looks like at your scale? I can work around your calendar.

IF HE WANTS TO KNOW WHAT CHANGES ON THE FLOOR

Nothing changes about how the day is planned. What changes is that when the day drifts, something notices inside the minute and acts. It pulls a specific agent for a specific coaching module because there is real slack right now, or pushes deferred work into a lull, and it logs what it did so you can see the recovered time as a number.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Ben, left you a voicemail too. The short version: the queue wins, so coaching slips, so quality slips, so the queue gets worse next week. Everyone treats that loop as physics and it is not, because the slack to break it is already inside the shift. Twenty minutes on where yours sits?

planned versus happened

Ben, a different angle on the same problem.

Workforce management tells you what the day should look like. Forecast, schedule, adherence targets. It is good at that, and it is not the gap.

The gap is what happens when the day does not match: a spike, a callout, an outage, a promotion that lands harder than modelled. Something has to decide, inside the hour, what gives. In most operations that is a supervisor with a spreadsheet and a judgment call, made forty times a day, differently each time.

That decision is automatable without touching the plan or the platform that made it.

{{sender}}

TOUCH 5 • DAY 8 • CALL #1, FULL SCRIPT

OPENER

Ben, {{sender}} with Intradiem. Two notes in, and I would rather just ask.

THE FRAME

TELUS has committed to roughly \$600 million of operational effectiveness work this year and said in the same July release that customer service has to get better, not just cheaper. Those land on your title simultaneously. What I cannot work out from the outside is whether anyone at TELUS is working the recovered-capacity side of that, or whether it is all deflection and self-serve.

THE ASK

Twenty minutes. Not a demo, not an evaluation. If TELUS has the capacity side covered, I will stop.

IF HE SAYS THEY ALREADY USE AI

They do, and the results are real. The distinction worth drawing is between AI that improves an interaction and AI that orchestrates the workforce around the interactions. Different problems. Most programmes fund the first, which is precisely why the capacity keeps arriving with nowhere to put it.

TOUCH 6 • DAY 10 • CALL #2, SHORT

Ben, {{sender}} with Intradiem, last call. One question. When the day goes off-plan at TELUS, is the response automated or is it a supervisor's judgment call? Either answer is fine and it tells me whether to stop.

TOUCH 7 • DAY 12 • EMAIL, HAIL-MARY

one line

Ben, I will stop after this.

The whole idea in a sentence: the capacity you need is already inside the shift you paid for, and the only reason it does not get used is that nothing is watching the floor in the moment and acting on it.

If that is already solved at TELUS, genuinely good. If it is not, I am easy to find.

{{sender}}

TOUCH 8 • DAY 14 • BREAKUP EMAIL

last note

Ben, closing this out, no reply needed. If the distance between the plan and the day ever becomes someone's project, I would want to be in that conversation.

{{sender}}

Dave Richardson

Senior Vice President, Business Customer Experience

Hook. B2B care is a different animal from consumer care. A service failure does not churn a line, it puts a contract in play. And Business Solutions folds under a brand-new group president on September 1, which means his experience metric has to hold through a reorganisation and a \$600 million effectiveness programme at once.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 1 • EMAIL

the B2B version of the problem

Dave, most conversations about customer experience in telecom are really about consumer. Business is a different problem and it gets the consumer playbook applied to it more often than not.

When a consumer interaction goes badly you risk a line. When a business interaction goes badly, a provisioning error or a billing dispute that takes three calls, you put a contract in play and the account team finds out weeks later.

Business Solutions moves under TELUS Communications on September 1, in the same year TELUS has roughly \$600 million of operational effectiveness work running. Holding the B2B experience steady through both is a specific job, and it is yours.

Twenty minutes on what usually gives first?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 2 • DAY 2 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Dave, business customer experience gets the consumer playbook applied to it more often than it should, and the failure modes are not the same. A bad B2B interaction puts a contract in play rather than a line. That difference is most of what I think about. Would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • VOICEMAIL

Dave, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent a note about B2B experience being a genuinely different problem from consumer, and about holding it steady while Business Solutions moves under TELUS Communications in September. I am at [number]. The email is the easier reply. Thanks Dave.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF HE PICKS UP

OPENER

Dave, {{sender}} with Intradiem. Thirty seconds and then it is your call.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

I called because business customer experience fails differently than consumer, and most tooling is built for consumer. In B2B the damage is slow. A provisioning error, a dispute that takes three touches, an escalation that sits. It surfaces as a contract conversation months later rather than a churn event on a dashboard. Which means the recovery work is where your risk lives, and recovery work is exactly what gets deprioritised when the queue is hot.

CLOSE

Twenty minutes on what gives first when it gets hot? I will work around you.

IF HE WANTS THE MECHANISM

Recovery work stops depending on someone having a quiet afternoon. The system finds the quiet afternoon and books the work into it.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Dave, left you a voicemail. The short of it: in B2B the damage from a bad interaction is slow and surfaces as a contract conversation rather than a churn number, so the recovery work is where the real risk sits. Recovery work is also the first thing dropped when the queue is hot. Twenty minutes on that?

TOUCH 4 • DAY 6 • EMAIL

it is not only the phone queue

Dave, a second angle, and the one people usually miss on the business side.

Most of what makes a B2B customer unhappy never happens on a call. It happens in order provisioning, in a billing correction, in a contract change that takes eleven days because it moves through four queues and nobody owns the whole path. The call is where the customer tells you about it.

We work both halves, the contact centre and the back office behind it, because on the business side the back office is usually where the experience is actually decided.

Worth twenty minutes on the second half?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 5 • DAY 9 • BREAKUP EMAIL

closing this

Dave, closing the loop rather than sending a fourth note.

If the question ever becomes how to hold the business experience steady while the operational programme runs, particularly the back-office half, that is the conversation I would want. Otherwise, good luck through the September transition.

{{sender}}

Dionne Dames

Director, Contact Center AI, Digital and Sales Acceleration

LINKEDIN-ONLY

Hook. Contact-centre AI is literally her title, at the company whose own subsidiary published the number showing that the specific layer in question is the least-deployed part of the market. She is the one person in the committee who knows the real answer, and asking her for it is a genuine question rather than a pretext.

Why LinkedIn-only. Clay's waterfall returned only `ddames@telus.net`. That is TELUS's consumer ISP mail domain, not a corporate mailbox, so it is a personal home inbox that happens to sit on her employer's network. Sending business outreach there is worse than a bounce. No business address was resolvable, so she runs on LinkedIn and the email gets resolved only if she engages, when it is worth spending on. Same discipline as Ann Cullingham on Bell and Matt Turnbull on BMO.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 1 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Dionne, contact-centre AI is your title, so you will have a real answer to something I have been sitting with. TELUS Digital's own 2026 survey put AI-powered quality assurance and agent coaching at 32% deployment across 815 enterprises. I would like to know which side of that number a company like TELUS lands on. Would value connecting.

TOUCH 2 • DAY 4 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Dionne, thanks for connecting. What stuck with me about that 32% is that 46% of the same sample said they plan to invest. So the gap is not belief, it is fourteen points of deployment. Your team is the one place that would know whether it is technical, budgetary, or further down the list than agent assist. What do you think those fourteen points are made of?

TOUCH 3 • DAY 8 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Dionne, last one from me, and it is a theory rather than a question. Agent assist is easy to fund because the value is legible inside one interaction. Quality assurance and coaching are hard to fund because the value shows up as capacity, one shift at a time, and nobody has a dashboard for capacity recovered rather than lost. If that is right, the blocker is instrumentation rather than AI. If it is wrong I would rather know.

Brad Harper

Vice President, Workforce
Solutions

LINKEDIN-ONLY

Hook. Twenty-eight years at TELUS, running workforce solutions. He is the person who actually knows what the stack is, which is why every message to him asks rather than asserts. The one distinction worth drawing with him is the cleanest in the whole document: workforce management plans the day, and nothing acts on the day.

Why LinkedIn-only. Clay's waterfall did not return a business address for him across two polling passes. Per the standing rule that is a LinkedIn-first seat rather than a second billable enrichment pass, because the credits are worth spending once he engages, not before.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 1 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Brad, twenty-eight years in workforce solutions at one company means you have seen every version of this argument, which is exactly why I would value the connection. The thing I keep running into: workforce management is genuinely good at planning the day, and there is nothing underneath it that acts on the day. Curious whether that matches your experience or whether I have the wrong end of it.

TOUCH 2 • DAY 4 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Brad, thanks for connecting. A real question rather than a pitch, because I would rather ask than guess from a five-year-old press release. When the day goes off-plan at your scale, what closes the gap? Forecast and schedule handle the plan, adherence tells you afterward how far off it went. I am interested in the middle hour, where a spike has already happened and something must decide what gives. Automated, or supervisors?

TOUCH 3 • DAY 9 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Brad, closing the loop and leaving the useful part behind. The distinction I would draw: workforce management is a planning system, judged on how good the plan was. Orchestration is an execution system, judged on what happened to the plan. Most operations own the first and have nothing for the second, so supervisors absorb the gap and the capacity quietly disappears. If TELUS has that second layer, I would like to hear what it is.

Megan Routly

Director, Client Service
Management

HUMILITY CLAUSE

Hook. She runs the escalation layer, which is where the difference between the roster and the actual day gets absorbed by people. She will know all of this already. The right posture is to say so.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 1 • EMAIL

probably obvious from where you sit

Megan, you know your own operation better than I do from the outside, so treat this as a question rather than an observation.

Client service management is where the distance between the roster and the day ends up. The schedule said one thing, the day did another, and somebody's team absorbs the difference, usually by dropping the work that has no immediate deadline. Coaching, quality review, the follow-up that prevents the next escalation.

What I have never been able to see from outside an operation is whether that absorption is visible to anyone as a number, or whether it just reads as a good team working hard.

Worth twenty minutes?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 2 • DAY 2 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Megan, client service management is where the distance between the roster and the actual day gets absorbed, and usually by people rather than by a system. You will have a much sharper view of that than I do from outside. Would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • VOICEMAIL

Megan, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent a note asking whether the gap between the roster and the day is visible as a number in your world, or whether it just looks like a team working hard. It is a genuine question. I am at [number], email is easier. Thanks Megan.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF SHE PICKS UP

OPENER

Megan, thirty seconds from {{sender}} at Intradiem, and then tell me to go away if this is not useful.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

I called with a question rather than a pitch. In every operation I see, the difference between what was scheduled and what actually happened gets absorbed by the escalation layer, which is your layer, and it gets absorbed by dropping whatever has no deadline. Coaching, quality review, the follow-up that stops the next escalation. What I cannot see from outside is whether anybody counts that, or whether it shows up as a team that copes well.

CLOSE

Twenty minutes, and I will probably get more out of it than you do. Worth it?

IF SHE WANTS THE MECHANICS

Something that spots genuine slack as it happens and puts the deferred work into it automatically, rather than leaving it to whoever remembers.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Megan, voicemail too. The question in one line: does the distance between the roster and the day show up anywhere as a number in your world, or does it just look like a team coping well? Genuinely curious, because from outside an operation those two look identical and they are not.

TOUCH 4 • DAY 6 • EMAIL

the thing that never gets scheduled

Megan, a follow-on thought.

The work that gets dropped when the day goes sideways is almost always the work that prevents the next bad day. Coaching, quality review, the root-cause follow-up on an escalation. All of it important, none of it urgent, all of it first to go.

What we do is narrow. Watch for the moments in the day when there is genuine slack, and push that deferred work into it automatically, in the moment, instead of hoping someone remembers on a quiet Friday.

Twenty minutes?

{{sender}}

no reply needed

Megan, closing this out.

If the never-urgent work ever becomes something someone wants to schedule automatically rather than hope for, that is the conversation I would want. Thanks for the time reading these.

{{sender}}

Matt Murray

Senior Vice-President, Finance Business Partners

Hook. Finance Business Partners is the function that sits with each operating unit and holds it to its number. The \$600 million is not an abstraction to him; it is a set of conversations he is personally having with the people who have to deliver it.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 1 • EMAIL

the hundred million

Matt, the number that caught my attention was not the \$600 million. It was the revision.

TELUS moved its full-year restructuring assumption from approximately \$500 million to approximately \$600 million and said the increase came from expanded operational effectiveness programs supporting EBITDA and cash flow growth. A revision reads differently from an announcement. It means the programmes were already running and needed more room than the original plan gave them.

Your function is where that lands as a conversation rather than a line item. Twenty minutes on the part of it that does not require a charge?

{{sender}}

[PENDING Q2 CALL] — written off the Q1 MD&A because that is the strongest disclosed source at build time. If Chande restates the restructuring envelope, quantifies the programme, or names an efficiency target on the Q2 call, replace paragraph two outright with her words and the call date, and keep the revision logic only if guidance actually moved again. This is the seat where a four-month-old filing is most visible as a four-month-old filing.

TOUCH 2 • DAY 2 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Matt, the interesting thing about TELUS's restructuring guidance was not the \$600 million, it was that it was a revision upward with a stated reason. Revisions say the programmes were already running. Your function is where that becomes a conversation with each unit rather than a line item. Would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • VOICEMAIL

Matt, {{sender}} with Intradiem. My note was about the restructuring guidance moving from roughly \$500 million to roughly \$600 million, and why a revision reads differently from an announcement. There is a version of that work which does not require a charge, and that is the twenty minutes I am asking for. I am at [number]. Thanks Matt.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF HE PICKS UP OPENER

Matt, {{sender}} with Intradiem. Thirty seconds, then tell me whether to keep going.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

I called about the restructuring revision rather than the reorganisation. Five hundred million to six hundred, with expanded operational effectiveness programmes named as the cause. That tells me the work is in flight and the original envelope was too small. It also raises a question your function owns more than anyone. How much of the remaining effectiveness has to come through a charge, and how much can come from the operation running better? Those are different instruments with different accounting and very different durability.

CLOSE

Twenty minutes on the second one? I can work around you.

IF HE ASKS HOW IT BOOKS

As an operating layer rather than a project. It recovers usable time from inside shifts you already pay for, which is why it lands as a run rate instead of a charge.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Matt, left a voicemail. In one line: how much of the remaining operational effectiveness has to come through a charge, and how much can come from the operation simply running better? Those are different instruments with very different durability, and your function is where the answer gets decided. Twenty minutes?

charge versus run rate

Matt, the distinction I would actually want twenty minutes for.

A restructuring charge buys a one-time change to the cost base. It is a real instrument, it works, and it is finite. You can only do it as many times as you have things to restructure, and each time costs cash plus something harder to put in a model.

Capacity recovered from inside the existing operation behaves differently. No charge, a run rate rather than a step change, and it compounds instead of depleting. It is also slower to stand up, which is the actual reason it loses to a charge in a planning cycle. Not because it is worse, because it does not land inside the quarter someone needs it.

If any part of 2027 planning is about where effectiveness comes from next, I would want to be in that.

{{sender}}

[PENDING Q2 CALL] — the closing paragraph assumes the programmes stay framed as finite. If Chande instead describes operational effectiveness as an ongoing capability, or attaches a multi-year target, that framing is wrong and the last paragraph must be rewritten to sit inside hers rather than against it.

one last thought

Matt, closing this out rather than sending another.

The whole of it: there is a version of operational effectiveness that does not require a charge, it is slower, and it gets cut from planning cycles for exactly that reason. If it ever comes up on your side of the table, I would be glad to be useful.

{{sender}}

Lynn Salekin

Vice President, Finance Shared Services

Hook. This is the only seat in the committee with no contact-centre content whatsoever, and it exists to prove that this is not a call-centre pitch. Shared services is transaction processing at volume, the exact shape of work orchestration was built for, and the half of the category almost nobody sequences.

TOUCH 1 • DAY 1 • EMAIL

the half nobody sequences

Lynn, most vendors in my category write to contact centre leaders and stop there. It is a habit rather than a reason, and it means shared services gets sold the same story with the nouns changed.

Finance shared services is a processing operation. Volume arrives, it queues, it gets worked by people whose throughput varies by hour, and month-end does not care about your staffing model. The constraint is different from a contact centre though. Nobody is waiting on the line, so the pressure surfaces as backlog and cycle time rather than as a queue metric someone watches live.

That difference is why the same problem goes unaddressed longer here. Twenty minutes on where the backlog accumulates?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 2 • DAY 2 • LINKEDIN CONNECTION REQUEST

Lynn, my category writes to contact centre leaders and stops, which means shared services gets the same story with the nouns swapped. The constraint is genuinely different: no one is waiting on the line, so it surfaces as backlog and cycle time rather than a live queue metric. That gap is what I would want to talk about. Would value connecting.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • VOICEMAIL

Lynn, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. My note was about shared services being a processing operation with a different constraint from a contact centre, backlog and cycle time rather than a live queue, and why that means the problem sits unaddressed longer. I am at [number], email is the easier reply. Thanks Lynn.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LIVE-ANSWER SCRIPT, IF SHE PICKS UP

OPENER

Lynn, {{sender}} with Intradiem here. Thirty seconds, and then tell me if this is irrelevant.

THE THIRTY SECONDS

I called because my category almost always sells to contact centres and treats shared services as an afterthought, and I think that is backwards. You run a processing operation where volume arrives, queues and gets worked, with throughput varying by person and by hour. The difference is that nobody is waiting on the line, so nothing forces a response in the moment. It surfaces later as backlog and cycle time, which means the slack in the day never gets reallocated, because nothing is watching for it.

CLOSE

Twenty minutes on where the backlog builds and what usually causes it? I will work around your calendar.

IF SHE WANTS THE DETAIL

It reads queue state and real capacity together, then moves work and people against each other continuously rather than at the point someone notices a problem.

TOUCH 3 • DAY 4 • LINKEDIN MESSAGE

Lynn, voicemail as well. Short version: in shared services nothing forces a response in the moment, so the slack in a given day never gets reallocated and it surfaces a week later as backlog. Twenty minutes on where yours builds, and what usually causes it?

TOUCH 4 • DAY 6 • EMAIL

month-end

Lynn, one specific instead of a general.

The pattern I see most often in finance shared services is that the operation is staffed for an average and the work does not arrive on an average. Month-end, quarter-end, a systems change, a volume spike from somewhere upstream. The response is overtime, deferral, or both, and the recovery period eats the following week.

What orchestration does there is unglamorous. It watches the actual queue state and the actual capacity, and moves work and people against each other continuously rather than at the point where someone notices a problem.

Twenty minutes to see whether that maps to your cycle?

{{sender}}

TOUCH 5 • DAY 9 • BREAKUP EMAIL

stopping here

Lynn, no reply needed on this one.

If shared services ever becomes part of the operational effectiveness conversation rather than a downstream consequence of it, I would want to be in that discussion. Thanks for reading.

{{sender}}

Objection quick-handles

"TELUS Digital already does this. We own a company that sells it." The one that has to be answered well, because it is structurally true and every seat will raise it. TELUS Digital sells CX services to other enterprises, which is a revenue line, and it says nothing about the tooling inside TELUS Corporation's own operation. Then hand them their own evidence: TELUS Digital's June 2026 survey with Ryan Strategic Advisory put AI-powered quality assurance and agent coaching at 32% deployment across 815 enterprises, with 46% planning to invest. Their research group identified the gap. **Ask which side of it TELUS Corporation is on. Never assert which side.** If they answer that TELUS is on the deployed side, that is a genuinely good outcome, because it is a discovery answer nobody else would have got.

"We already have workforce management." Good, and we do not replace it. Workforce management is a planning system: forecast, schedule, adherence, judged on how good the plan was. We are an execution layer, judged on what happened to the plan. The two are complementary and the integration conversation is short. **Do not name a platform.** Ask what they run.

"We are already deploying AI in customer service." TELUS is, and it is real; agent co-pilots are in the centres. The distinction worth drawing is between AI that improves an interaction and AI that orchestrates the workforce around the interactions. Different problems. Most programmes fund the first, which is precisely why the capacity keeps arriving with nowhere to put it.

"This is about cutting headcount and we have said we won't." No, and this is the objection to get right rather than deflect. TELUS's public position is that AI should augment rather than replace, and the whole argument here sits on that side of the line. Capacity recovered from inside an existing shift means the people already there get their own time back, for coaching, for training, for the work that never gets scheduled. It does not produce a smaller team, and a rep who lets this slide into a cost-per-head conversation has lost the account. **Never argue the other side of this even hypothetically.**

"We just reorganised. Nobody knows who owns what yet." Entirely fair, and the reason the outreach waited six weeks rather than landing in July. Twenty minutes now is scoping rather than deciding, so it does not require an owner to exist yet. And when the owner does exist, having the shape of the problem already worked out is worth more than starting then.

"Send me information." Reframe to a specific twenty minutes. If they hold, the Humana material is the right thing to send and this is the only place it belongs: a five-year partnership, 7X return five years in, 2.7 million automated contact-centre actions in 2025, roughly two hours of capacity per agent per month. Named, public, customer-told. Never in a cold touch.

"Budget is committed for the year." Understood, and the shape of the case matters more than the timing. Capacity recovered from existing headcount is the rare line a committed-budget environment can still act on, and if it fits the plan it fits the next cycle rather than never. TELUS's 2027 planning is happening now.

"Talk to procurement / we have a process." Happy to. Twenty minutes first, so that what enters the process is scoped to a real problem rather than a category. Otherwise it gets evaluated against workforce management suites, which is the wrong comparison and takes twice as long.

"Why are you writing to me and not to Fuller, Chande or Dodig?" Answer honestly: because they are weeks into new roles and a cold email is a bad way to meet a new group president or a new CFO, and because the person who knows whether this is real is the person running the operation. Offer the escalation rather than dodging it. If the answer is that this belongs upstairs, ask for the introduction.

Claims basis

Every TELUS figure in this document is company-disclosed with a date, verified against a TELUS-hosted, TELUS Digital-hosted or regulator-published primary source in a live research pass on July 29-30 2026. The inbound brief's version of several of these was wrong; the corrections are logged below the table.

CLAIM	SOURCE	DATE
"Our restructuring and other costs assumption has been revised to approximately \$600 million, from approximately \$500 million"	TELUS Q1 2026 MD&A (SEC EDGAR / TELUS IR)	May 8, 2026
"We estimate total cash restructuring and other disbursements of approximately \$550 million, from approximately \$450 million"	TELUS Q1 2026 MD&A	May 8, 2026
"The increase is a result of expanded operational effectiveness programs to support EBITDA and cash flow growth"	TELUS Q1 2026 MD&A	May 8, 2026
Q1 2026 restructuring and other costs \$315M vs \$97M in Q1 2025; "cost efficiency and effectiveness programs, in addition to costs associated with the privatization of TELUS Digital"	TELUS Q1 2026 MD&A and results release	May 8, 2026
Q1 2026: revenue \$5.0B (-1%), adjusted EBITDA \$1.8B (flat), FCF \$583M (+19%), net income \$144M (-52%)	TELUS Q1 2026 results release	May 8, 2026
2026 targets: service revenue +2-4%, adjusted EBITDA +2-4%, FCF ~\$2.45B, capex ~\$2.3B (-10%)	TELUS Q4/FY2025 results and 2026 targets release	Feb 12, 2026
"cost reduction efforts, including workforce reductions, synergies achieved from the privatization of TELUS Digital, and reductions in marketing and administrative costs"	TELUS Q1 2026 MD&A	May 8, 2026
"This reorganization is designed to drive enhanced customer service... and realize operational efficiencies across the organization"	TELUS media release, "TELUS consolidates telecom businesses to drive sustainable growth"	Jul 22, 2026

Dodig: "This reorganization is the first step in a transformation to meet that challenge"	Same release	Jul 22, 2026
David Fuller appointed EVP and Group President, TELUS Communications, effective Sep 1 2026, with Consumer and Business Solutions under him. Prior: President of Rogers Wireless 2021-22, Operating Partner at Searchlight Capital	Same release, executive biographies	Jul 22, 2026
Navin Arora appointed EVP and Group President, Global Platform Businesses; Zainul Mawji departing after 25 years	Same release	Jul 22, 2026
Victor Dodig became President and CEO effective Jul 1 2026; previously President and CEO of CIBC 2014-2025, TELUS independent director since May 2022; announced Feb 12 2026	TELUS media releases (Entwistle retirement; Dodig tenure begins)	Feb 12 / Jul 1, 2026
Gopi Chande became CFO effective Jul 1 2026; previously CFO of TELUS Digital and TELUS Health; succeeded Doug French; announced May 8 2026	TELUS media release, CFO succession	May 8, 2026
Darren Entwistle retired Jun 30 2026, left the Board, CEO Emeritus, advising Dodig to Apr 30 2027	TELUS media release	Feb 12, 2026
"only 32% of enterprises selected AI-powered quality assurance (QA) and agent coaching"; "two-thirds lack the AI-powered QA and coaching tools needed to assess AI-assisted interactions at scale"; 46% plan to invest; n=815 across 12 countries and 19 verticals, fielded Q1 2026	TELUS Digital with Ryan Strategic Advisory, <i>Enterprise CX AI: 2026 Global Survey</i>	Jun 3, 2026
TELUS Digital / Cresta partnership, TELUS Digital as preferred implementation partner	TELUS Digital release	Jun 15, 2026
TELUS Digital privatization completed, ~US\$539M at US\$4.50/share, 92.7% to 100% ownership, ~\$150M annualized cash synergies rationale; ~\$115M annualized FCF synergies realized as at Q1 2026	TELUS media release; Q1 2026 MD&A	Oct 31, 2025 / May 8, 2026

TELUS official statement that AI "can augment ... not replace ... human capabilities"; Fuel iX Agent Assist mandated on "100% of retention calls" per a January 2026 internal email	CBC reporting (obtained internal document, TELUS statement on the record)	May 8, 2026
TELUS Digital positions Genesys Workforce Engagement Management on its CCaaS pages; Fuel iX Agent Assist and Agent Trainer shown at CCW Las Vegas	telusdigital.com CCaaS/Genesys page; TELUS Digital newsroom	2025-2026 / Jun 12, 2026
Verint Workforce Engagement deployed to ~30,000 TELUS International team members on Google Cloud	BusinessWire	May 20, 2021. Five years stale, wrong entity, marked [UNVERIFIED] for present tense
111,500 team members globally at Dec 31 2025; 25,200 in Canada	TELUS 2025 Annual Report (via third-party compilation)	Apr 2026
AI revenue ~\$800M in 2025, target ~\$2B by 2028	TELUS investor materials	2026
Fiscal year end December 31	TELUS filings	standing

Corrections to the inbound brief, logged

BRIEF SAID	ACTUALLY TRUE
The forcing function is the July 22 "operational efficiencies" phrase, with no figure attached, so the packet must wait for Q2	The July 22 release genuinely contains "realize operational efficiencies across the organization" and genuinely has no dollar figure . But the \$600 million restructuring revision with its stated rationale was disclosed May 8 and is a stronger forcing function than anything the Q2 call is likely to add. The premise that TELUS "has no equivalent sentence yet" was false.
78% increase in CCTS complaints, "the worst of the big three"	The 78% is real and is the largest year-over-year increase . Rogers held the highest share at 27% against TELUS's 21%, so "worst" is wrong. The figure also covers Aug 2024 to Jul 2025 and was published Jan 14 2026, a year stale. Excluded from all copy.
32% of enterprises lack "the automated quality assurance and coaching tools needed for feedback loops"	The source says "AI-powered quality assurance (QA) and agent coaching" and the consequence clause is "needed to assess AI-assisted interactions at scale." The brief's paraphrase is not quotable. Corrected wording used throughout.

Gopi Chande is a brand-new CFO, effective July 1,

Correct on the date, wrong on the framing. She was **CFO of TELUS Digital and TELUS Health**, an internal promotion

alongside a brand-new CEO	announced May 8 , not a July outside hire. That materially strengthens the finance angle, because she already owns contact-centre economics.
David Fuller starts September 1	Correct, and the brief gave no title. He is EVP and Group President, TELUS Communications , and he is a boomerang via BCG, President of Rogers Wireless, and Searchlight Capital . Omitting the Rogers and private-equity history loses the entire read on how he will think.
Verint Workforce Engagement across ~30,000 TELUS International team members, status unconfirmed	Correct and correctly dated, but the currency was implied wrongly. It is five years old and about a different entity . The current public signal is Genesys WEM plus Fuel iX . Marked [UNVERIFIED] and named nowhere in the copy.
Confirm the Q2 date "from TELUS investor relations early"	TELUS investor relations does not publish it . There is no advisory release. August 7 is third-party aggregator consensus only, and is treated as a planning assumption that may never be stated to a prospect.
Build the sequence to go dark around the earnings date	Not applicable once the launch moved to September 8. Q2 falls five weeks before Day 1 and Q3 falls after Day 9. A manufactured blackout would be copying Bell and BMO rather than reasoning about TELUS. Replaced with a pre-send gate.
Charter, AT&T Enterprise Group, Cox Enterprises and Liberty Global are the Technology & Communications customers to exclude	An independent screen of all 101 rows by industry and country found more : Virgin Media O2 (UK), Capita, Foundever (Sitel), DIRECTV, AT&T Entertainment Group and Cox Communications are also active customers, and ADT is one too, which is what bars the July 15 "ADT by Telus" story on two grounds rather than one. Liberty Global does not appear under that name. A fifth Canadian customer, CAA Club Group , is also present alongside the four the brief and memory listed.

Deliberately unused

[UNVERIFIED] and excluded from every message: the \$200 million offshoring savings figure attributed to a TELUS spokesperson but absent from all TELUS filings; TELUS's own contact-centre agent headcount, footprint or locations, which TELUS does not disclose anywhere; TELUS's specific complaint-increase percentage for the Aug 2025 to Jan 2026 CCTS mid-year period, which was not published; TELUS-specific AI accent-masking allegations, which are a sector-level union claim with no TELUS attribution; the TELUS Digital Bucharest job-cut figure, which reaches us through an aggregator citing a Romanian outlet with no primary confirmation.

Excluded although verifiable, on judgment rather than sourcing: the 2,800 Canadian roles lost in 2025 and the 56%-to-22% Canadian workforce share decline; the July 15 2026 ADT by Telus customer-service cuts in Calgary; the roughly 700 voluntary severance packages of January 2026; all union material including the March 2027 contract expiry; the CRTC junk-fee enforcement action and its \$10 million exposure. Each is real, dated and sourced. Each would also be read as opposition research by the person receiving it.

Pre-send gates

1. Dallas copy read.
2. Salesforce ownership and open-opportunity check on TELUS / TELUS Corporation, and the AE lane confirmed. Nathan's request did not name an owner for any of the three accounts.
3. **Confirm the Q2 2026 earnings date against telus.com investor relations in the first days of August.** If it lands in early August as expected, no action. If it has slipped into September, hold every touch within two business days either side of it. The date is never stated in a message regardless.
4. **Q2 refresh pass on the four [PENDING Q2 CALL] blocks:** Hesham Fahmy Touch 1 and Touch 4, Matt Murray Touch 1 and Touch 4. Each carries its own swap instruction inline. This is a narrow research pass on one earnings call, not a rebuild.
5. Mailbox warm on the sending address. Six addresses into telus.com across four days, on a domain where one address in nine came back `abuse`.
6. **Never send to ian.godfrey@telus.com.** `abuse` status, July 30 2026. He is off the committee, not deferred.
7. Dionne Dames and Brad Harper stay LinkedIn-only unless a business address resolves. Neither `@telus.net` address is ever used.
8. Confirm no touch names Rogers, Bell, ADT or any other active customer, and that no message equates operational efficiency with fewer people.
9. Confirm the Bell Canada document's two unapproved Intradiem metrics are struck. **Done July 29-30 2026**, the bullet was replaced with the current allowlist and the PDF rebuilt.

Nothing in this document sends without Dallas's approval. Every output stops at the human gate.